Daniel Grover

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Education

University of California, Berkeley — Berkeley, CA
Bachelor of Science in Mechanical Engineering (3.651 GPA) — *Expected May 2026*

Pi Tau Sigma Mechanical Engineering Honor Society — Berkeley, CA
Initiated after selection from top twenty-five percent of Junior class — *Initiated May 2025*

Merrill F West High School — Tracy, CA
Space and Engineering Academy Graduate with Honors - Salutatorian (4.58 GPA) — *Aug. 2018 – May 2022*

Skills

Design: Computer-Aided Design, Finite Element Analysis, GD&T
Software: SOLIDWORKS, Onshape, Fusion 360, MATLAB, C++, Python, Google Workspace, Microsoft Office
Manufacturing: 3D Printing, laser cutting, soldering, water-jetting, CNC routing
General: Communication, interpersonal skills, teamwork, leadership, flexibility, resourcefulness

Experience

Payload Lead & Project Manager — June 2024 – Present
Space Technologies & Rocketry — *Berkeley, CA*

- Leading the payload sub-team, running meetings & events, heading project work, and working with other leadership to meet club-wide goals.
- Created a club-wide workflow page in Notion to streamline tasks, timelines, budgets and documentation for multiple club projects.

Summer Student - Space Science & Security Program (SSSP) — May 2024 – August 2024
Lawrence Livermore National Laboratory (LLNL) — *Livermore, CA*

- Designed and successfully tested a novel design for wedgelocks in order to reduce lead times and manufacturing costs for the SSSP.
- Presented project work through a technical poster at the LLNL Summer Student Symposium.

Student Mechanical Engineer - Payload Team — Aug. 2023 – May 2024
Space Technologies & Rocketry — *Berkeley, CA*

- Worked with the payload sub-team to design and manufacture the Kinetically Engineered Life Support Experiment-Yeast (KELSE-Y).
- Engineered the payload structure, wrote design reports, and aided in testing the payload system.

Projects

RF Lander Payload | *Project Management, Onshape, Project Documentation* — May 2025 – Present

- Leading project work on a deploying payload that will achieve an upright landing after separating from a rocket airframe and use a solar cell to power an antenna to relay vital system information back to the team.
- Managing project timelines, assigning team members tasks, supporting team members, and collaborating with other club leads to integrate the payload into the club's LE3 rocket (planned launch Spring '26).

Wedgelock Redesign | *SOLIDWORKS, Rapid Prototyping, Project Management* — May 2024 – August 2024

- Created a single-part compliant device to mount printed circuit boards inside of mechanical enclosures.
- Created and presented a project poster at the Lawrence Livermore National Laboratory Summer Student Symposium.

KELSE-Y | *SOLIDWORKS, Assembly, Team Collaboration, Project Documentation* — August 2023 – May 2024

- Designed and manufactured a circulation system that removes carbon dioxide produced by yeast fermentation via a loop with a peristaltic pump and semi-permeable membrane.
- Worked with other subteams to integrate the circulation system and accompanying structure into the club's rocket Caldera (launched at Spaceport America Cup 2024).